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Class 4: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Mobilisation, recruitment, and participation

Dr. Michael C. Zeller

Agenda for the day

- Opening notes
- Klausur preview
- Forming presentation groups
- Networks
- Open data - suffragette networks
- Poll: org. change and youth
- Organisations
- Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Opening notes

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- clarification: assigned SM groups are **not** for a presentation or a groupwork assignment; they are for you to study independently and discuss in class (to help apply and clarify concepts)

Presentation groups

December | January

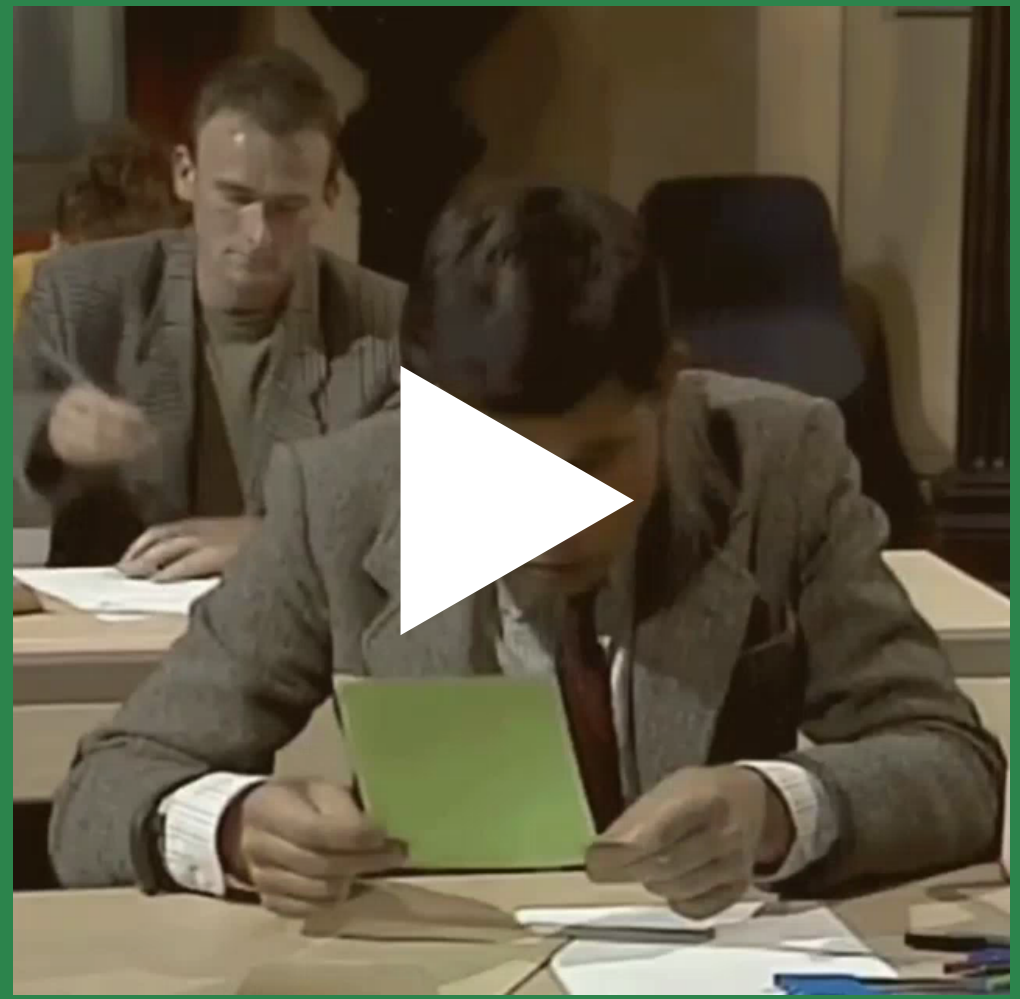
Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
7 Dec:		TBD
14 Dec:		TBD
21 Dec:		TBD

Klausur preview

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- structure of an essay
  1. Broad introductory response
  2. Elaborate in (sufficient) detail to answer the questions
  3. Describe examples
  4. Concluding summary



Klausur preview (1)

1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
3. Describe examples
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

Klausur preview (1)

2. Elaborate in detail

3. Describe examples

4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

1. Broad introduction

Political opportunity structure (POS) refers to availabilities of resources, institutional arrangements, and histories of mobilisation that shape (facilitating/hindering) movement activity. Different aspects of these components are relevant to different movements. But POS in all cases is an important part of explaining if and how movements form, how they operate, and whether and what kinds of impacts they can have. …

Klausur preview (2)

1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
3. Describe examples
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

Klausur preview (2)

1. Broad introduction
3. Describe examples
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

2. Elaborate in detail

POS defines what resources are available for emergent movements to use, whether they can access the public sphere and/or political decision-making, and whether there are viable models of mobilisation and campaigning. While individuals and groups always have some possibility of exercising their *agency*, the *structure* referred to by POS is a powerful constraining set of factors. …

Klausur preview (3)

1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
3. Describe examples
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

Klausur preview (3)

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1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

3. Describe examples

At a most basic level, POS can refer to the freedom for movements to form, to mobilise and campaign for certain goals. Authoritarian states typically restrict this freedom and offer less space for movements than in liberal democratic states like Germany. Looking closely at specific examples can demonstrate how POS shapes movements. The anti-nuclear movement in Germany, for example, benefited by forming in the wake of 1968-era mobilisations, so models existed for mobilising. Germany's federal state structure presented more 'opportunities' for movements to disrupt implementation of nuclear projects. Critical

events, such as Cold War missile installation and the Chernobyl accident, strengthened th[illegible]e[illegible]. And Germany's (PR) electoral system made the creation of a political party (i.e., institutio[illegible]a creation of elite allies) a viable option. Germany's virtually non-existent nuclear power infrastructure is evidence of the anti-nuclear movements success in Germany, contrasted with less successful movement activity in, e.g., France. …

Klausur preview (4)

1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
3. Describe examples
4. Concluding summary

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

Klausur preview (4)

1. Broad introduction
2. Elaborate in detail
3. Describe examples

What does 'political opportunity structure' mean? How does it help us understand how movements emerge and (potentially) have an impact? Discuss with examples

4. Concluding summary

To assess whether and in what ways movements can emerge, whether and in what ways movements can have an impact, it is essential to consider relevant POS aspects. Movements exercise their agency within the limitations created by POS.

Forming presentation groups

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- 2-4 students
- rank three possible dates for presentation
- for later:
  1. find research article of interest
  2. what method is used: is it of interest too?



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Networks

- opening questions
- network membership
- social network example
- mobilising networks and collective action



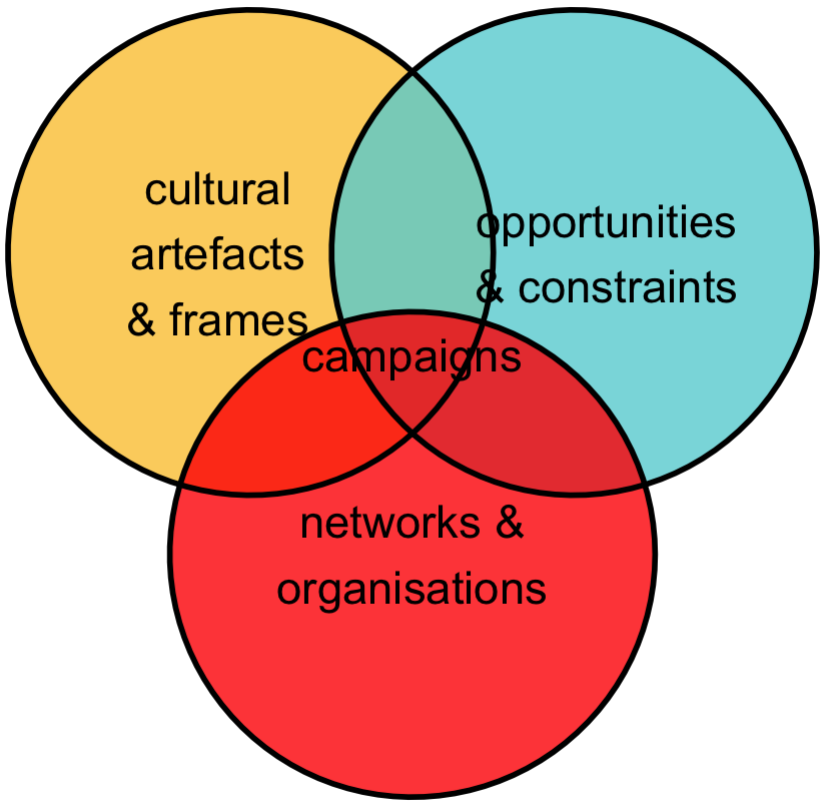
Opening question

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What types of social networks exist? Where? (When?)

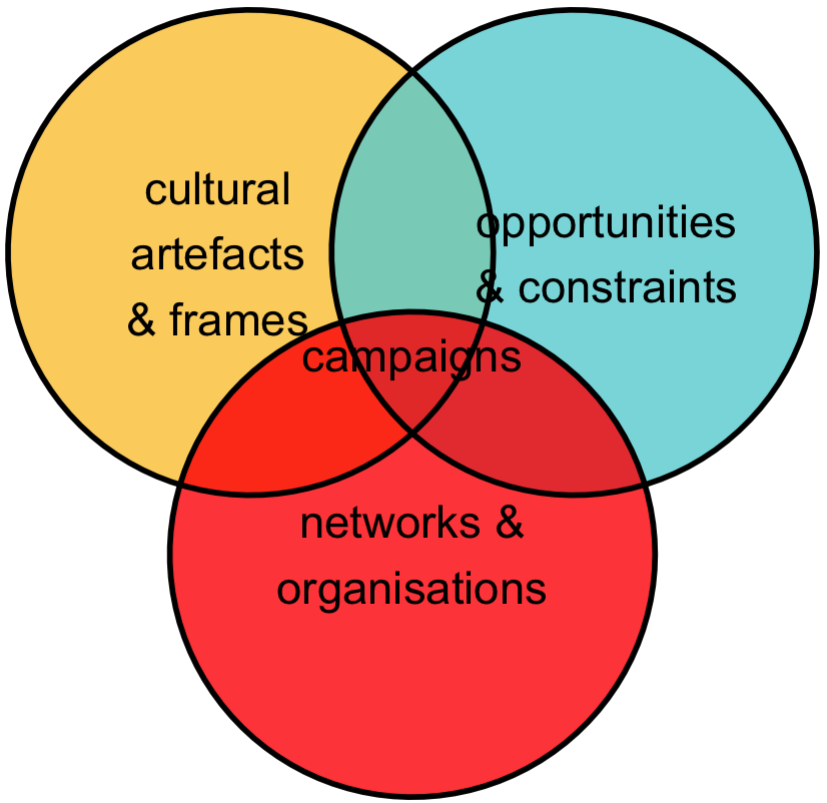
Network membership

- (nearly) everyone is a member of *multiple* social networks
  - some *informal* and loose
  - others *formalised*, with clearly defined structure



Network membership

- (nearly) everyone is a member of *multiple social networks*
  - some *informal* and loose
  - others *formalised*, with clearly defined structure
- networks have many functions
  - knowledge/info. sharing
  - coordinating action
  - others?



Network membership

Social network example - Barabási (2016, 17)

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Social network example - Barabási (2016, 17)

- now, identifying network influence of ranks in company hierarchy
- no directors are hubs. Nor are the top managers
- biggest hub (most influential individual) is an ordinary employee



Social network example - Barabási (2016, 17)

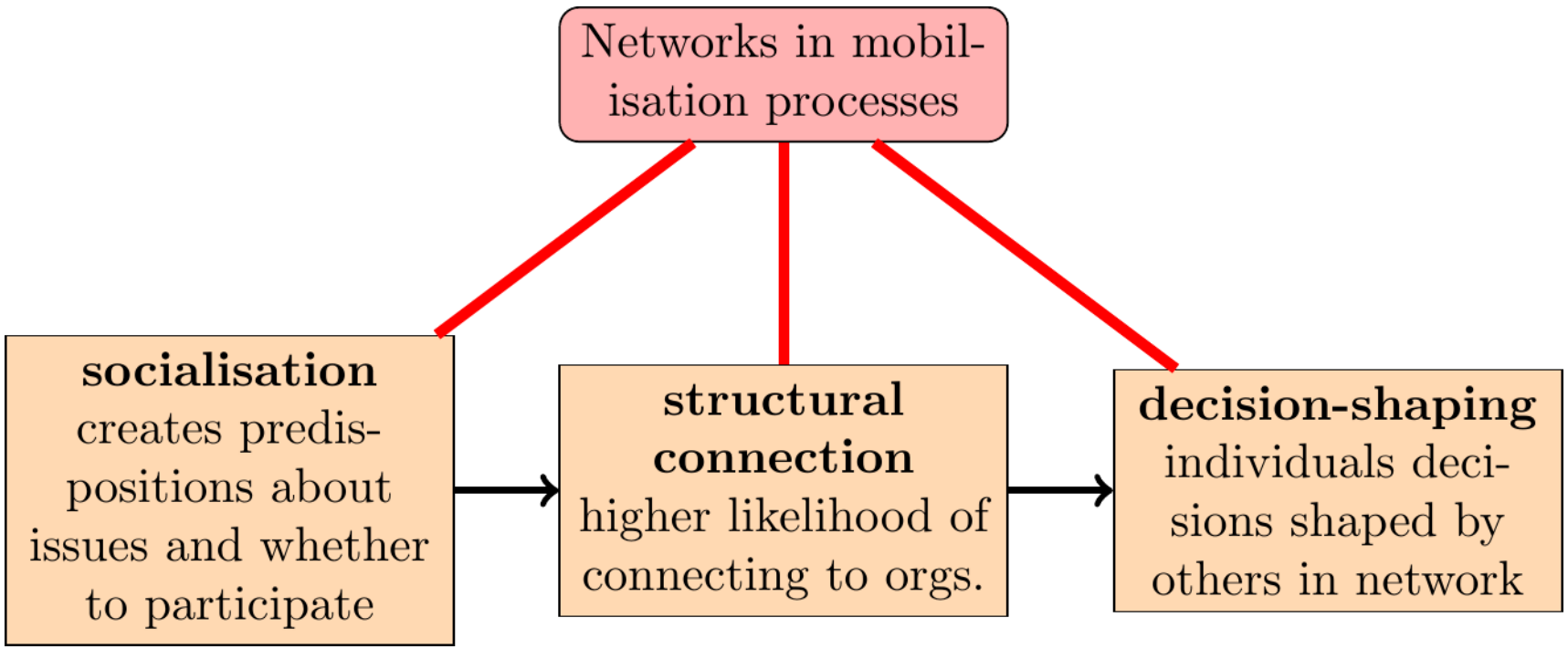
- many employees at most two links from the big hub, an employee in charge of safety issues
  - regularly visits each location and talks with the employees; connected to everyone except the top management; acts as a gossip centre



Mobilising networks and collective action (della Porta & Diani 2009, 115–16)

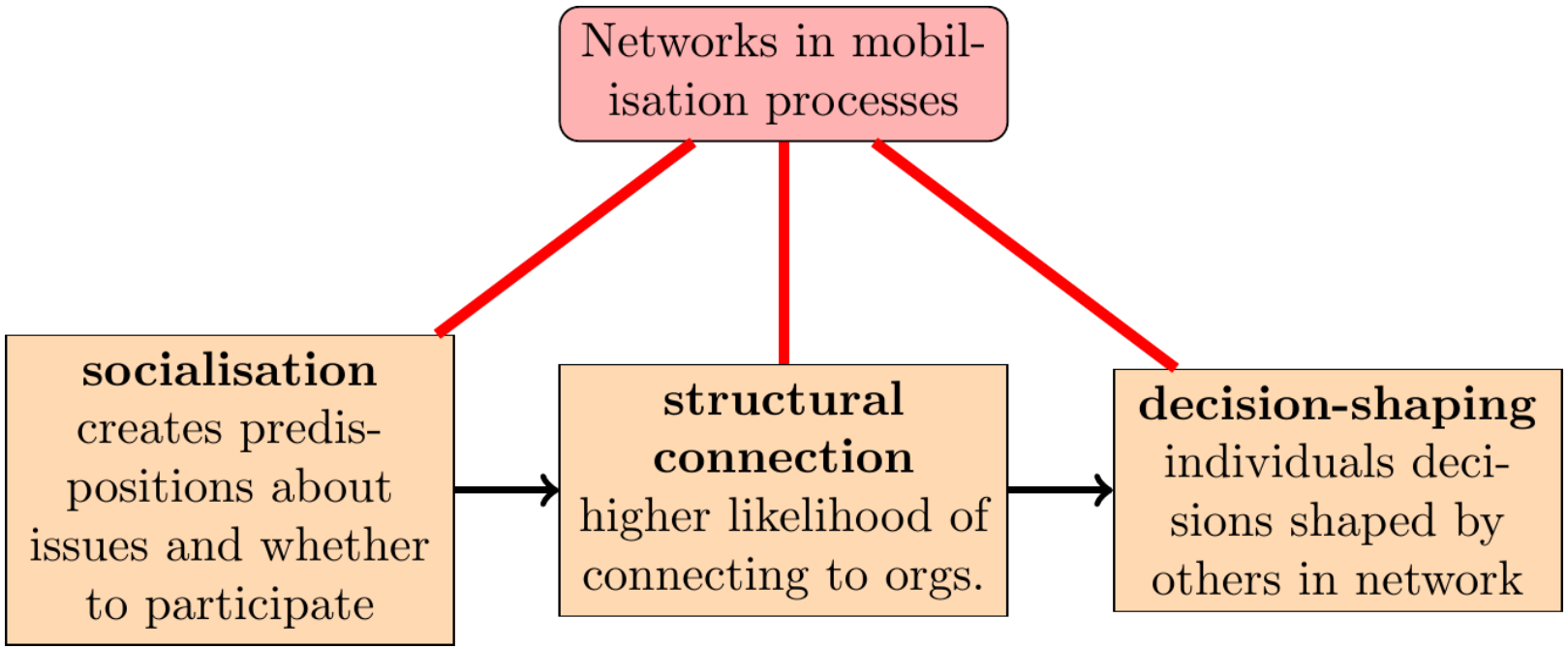
Networks and individuals' decisions to participate

How do social networks affect decisions to participate in collective action? (2009, 118–19)



> Mobilization in social movements frequently occurs through mechanisms of "**bloc recruitment**" (Oberschall, 1973): cells, branches, or simply significant groups of members of existing organizations are **recruited as a whole to a new movement**, or contribute to the start of new campaigns (della Porta and Diani 2009, 120)

Networks and individuals' decisions to participate



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what are the mobilising networks in cases you know of?

Individuals in networks, summing up

- networks perform many functions
  - socialisation (i.e., acquiring [political] values, beliefs, behaviours)
  - influencing individuals' decisions/sympathies
    - should I stay involved?
    - should I advocate for more radical actions?
    - should I support different leadership?

Individuals in networks, summing up

- networks are important, but *not necessary and not solely sufficient* for mobilisation of an individual
  - powerful combination of **strong commitment** and **strong ties to other participants** = *continued participation*
  - amenable networks and frame resonance are sufficient to mobilise individuals (without need of prior connection to an org.) (cf. della Porta and Diani 2009, 125)

Further on networks... with Manuel Castells:

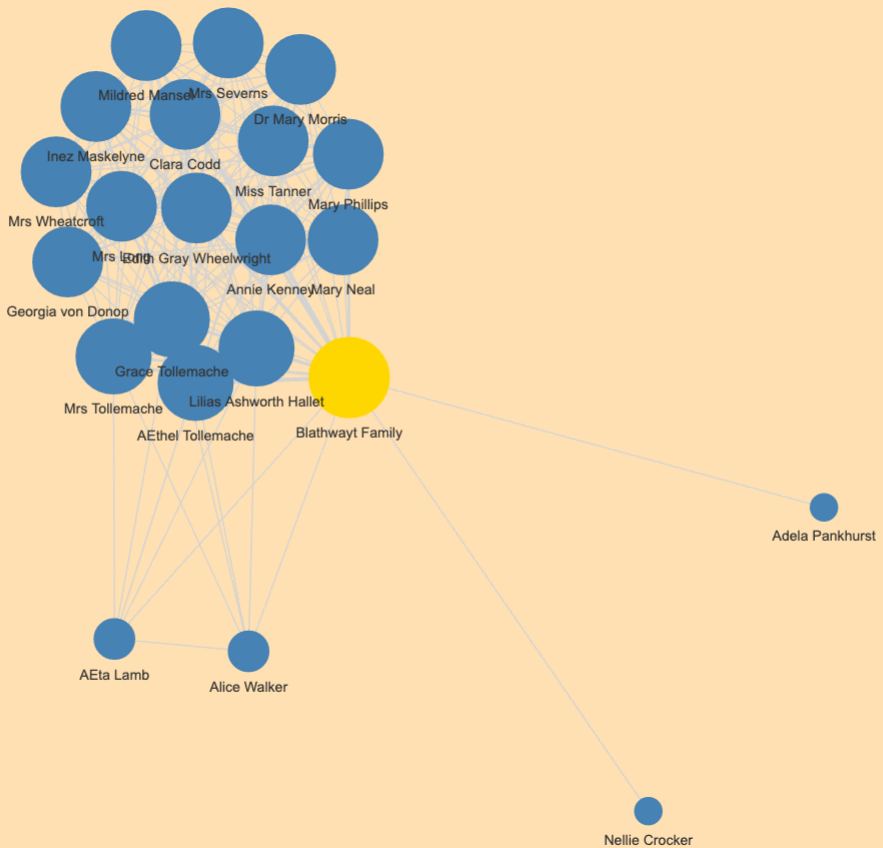
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Open data - suffragette networks

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1908 | 1909 | 1910 | 1911 | 1912 | 1913 | Explanatory note

Select by id



Poll: org. change and youth

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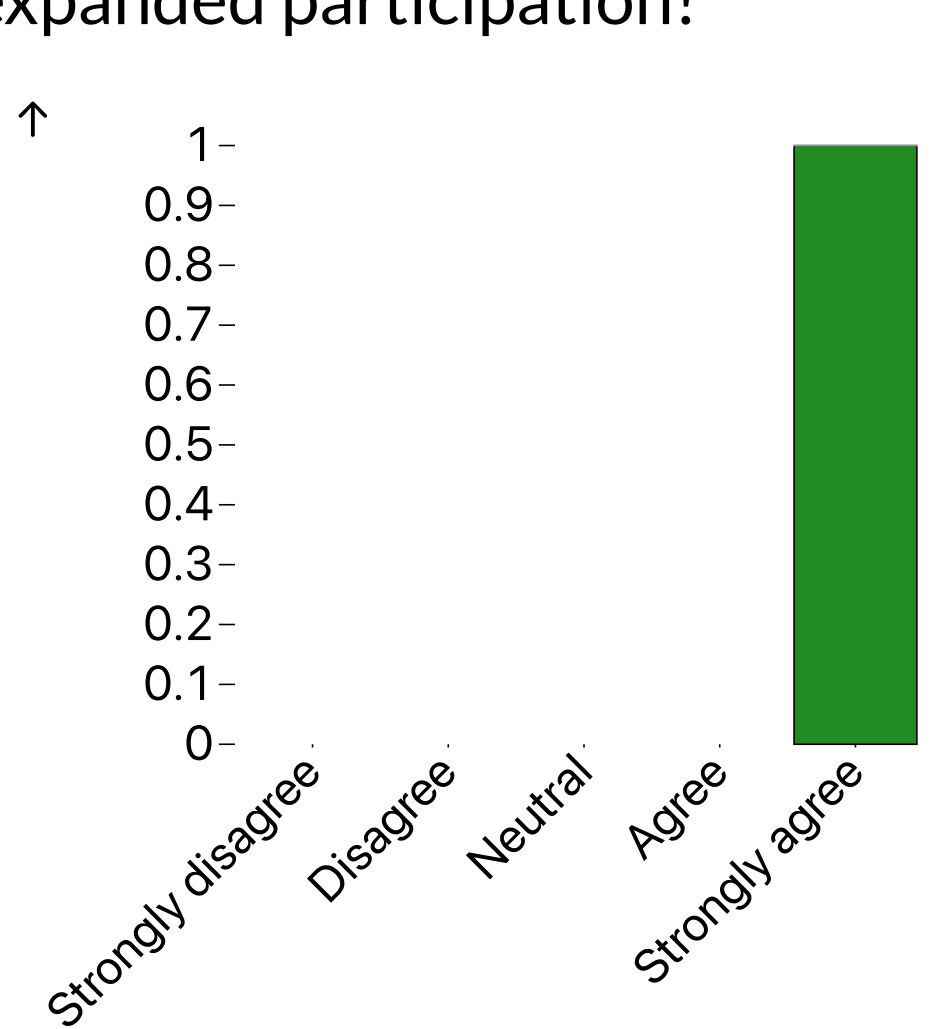
Take the survey at
https://forms.gle/soCtvvSX5TKuURp57

- social media networks have eased mobilisation?
- are offline, 'brick and mortar' orgs as important as ever?
- young people more prominent, numerous in activism?
- is it advantageous to have more young people in activism?

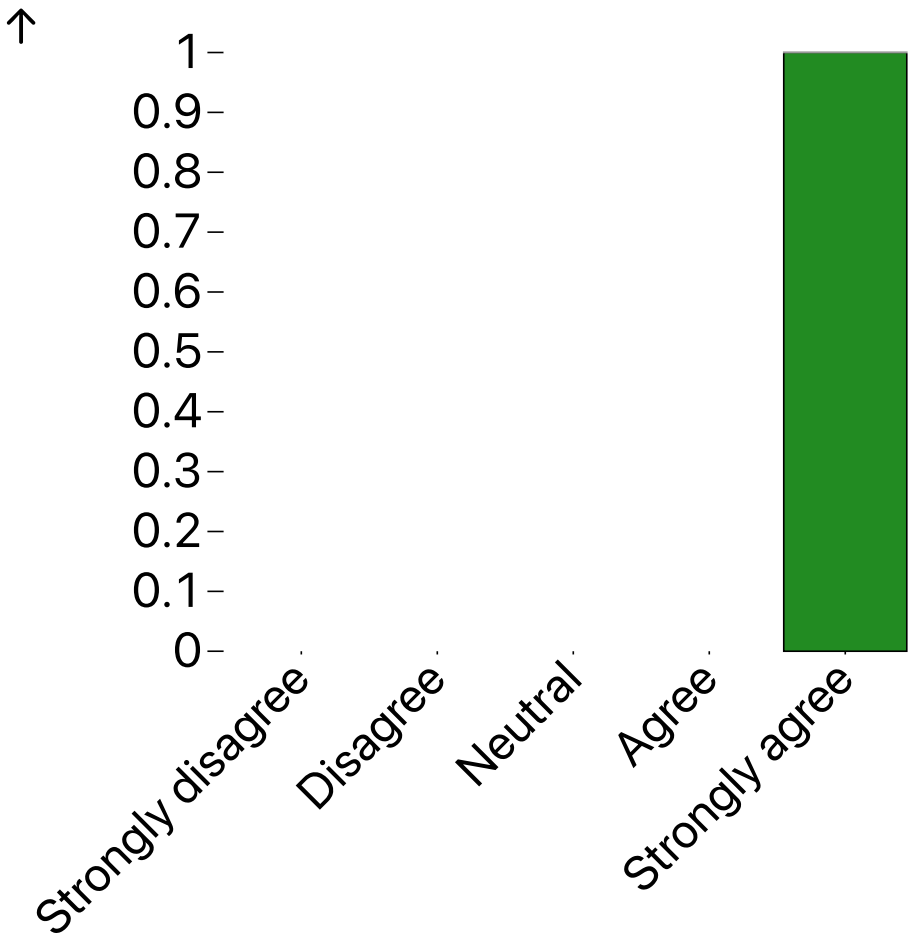
Questions about movements: (1) Does joining this movement require high level of commitment? (2) Does the movement rely heavily on social media? (3) Which setting plays the biggest role in mobilising support? (4) How are most participants recruited? (5) Which resource seems most important for this movement's success?

Poll results (Respondents: 1)

social media eased mobilisation, expanded participation?



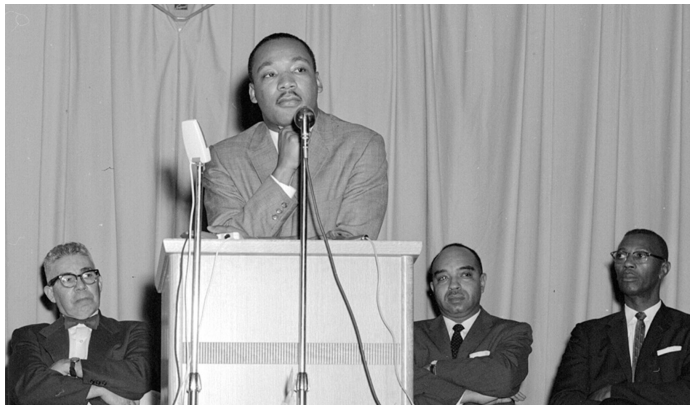
offline, orgs as important as ever




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Old-school organisation (American CRM)

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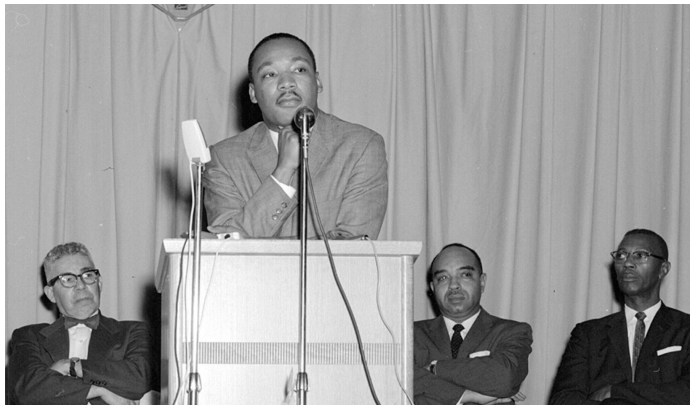




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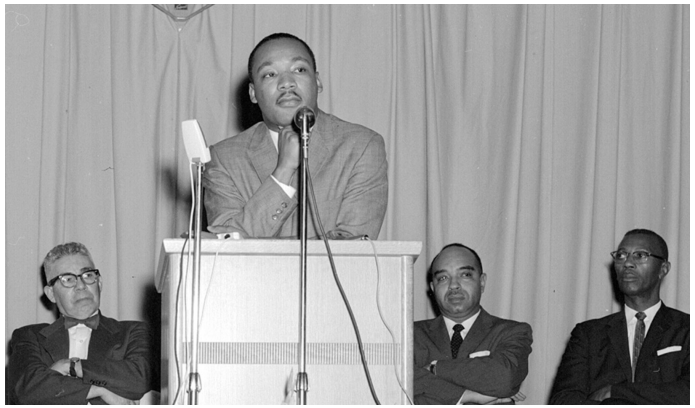
- MLK's 'I have a dream' speech (2
  - delivered previously, in N. Ca
    (27.11.1962) and in Detroit (23.6.1963)



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Old-school organisation (American CRM)

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- MLK's 'I have a dream' speech (2[illegible]9
  - delivered previously, in N. Ca[illegible] (27.11.1962) and in Detroit (23.6.1963)
- Bayard Rustin: capable, competent organisers in key positions
  - instead of standard 1000-2000 USD sound system, 16,000 USD state-of-the-art system

Tufekci (2017) on twitter netz, old-school orgs

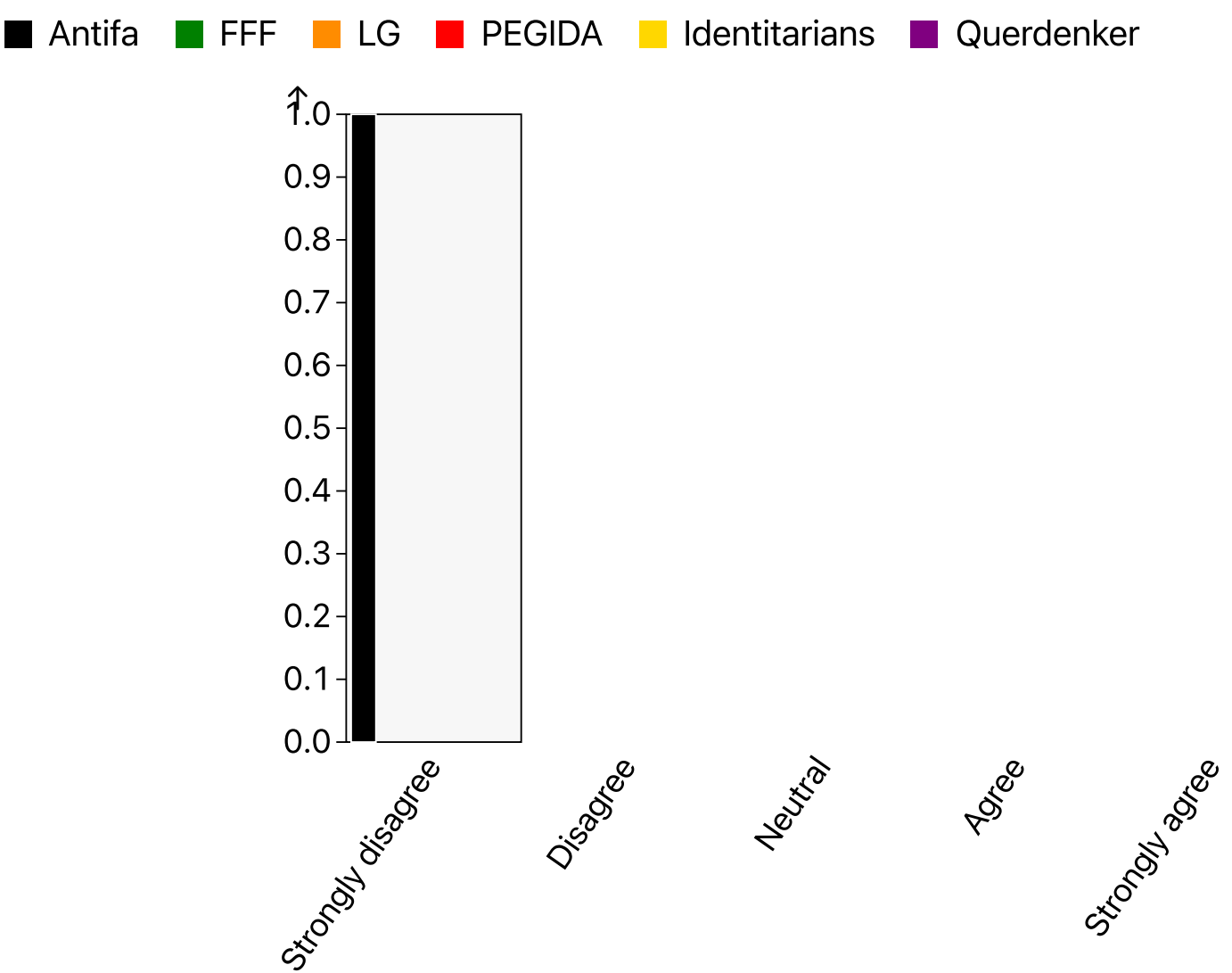
from start until 5.12



which social media platforms are you on? Could you imagine getting

Movement responses - commitment

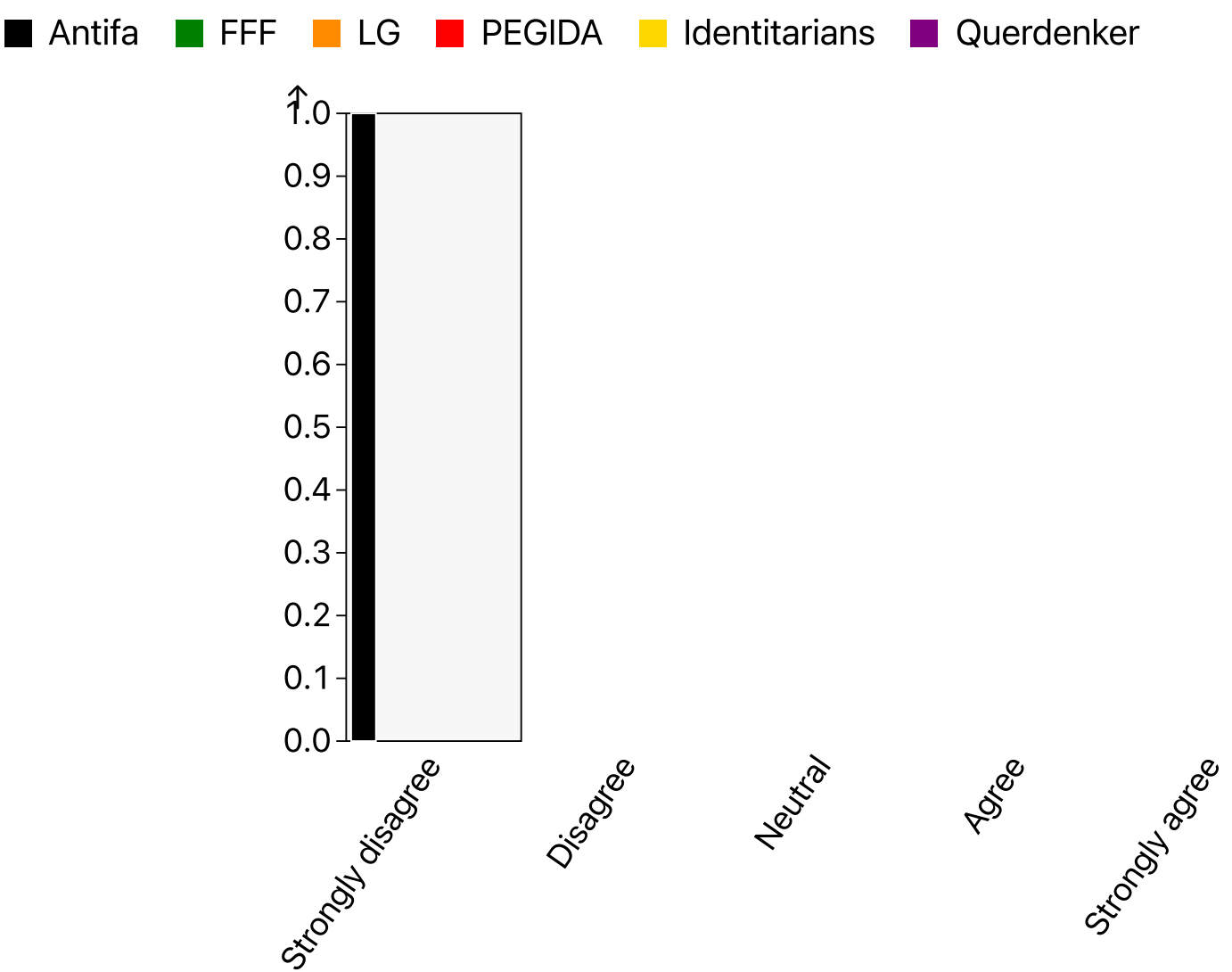
joining requires high commitment



Movement responses - joining

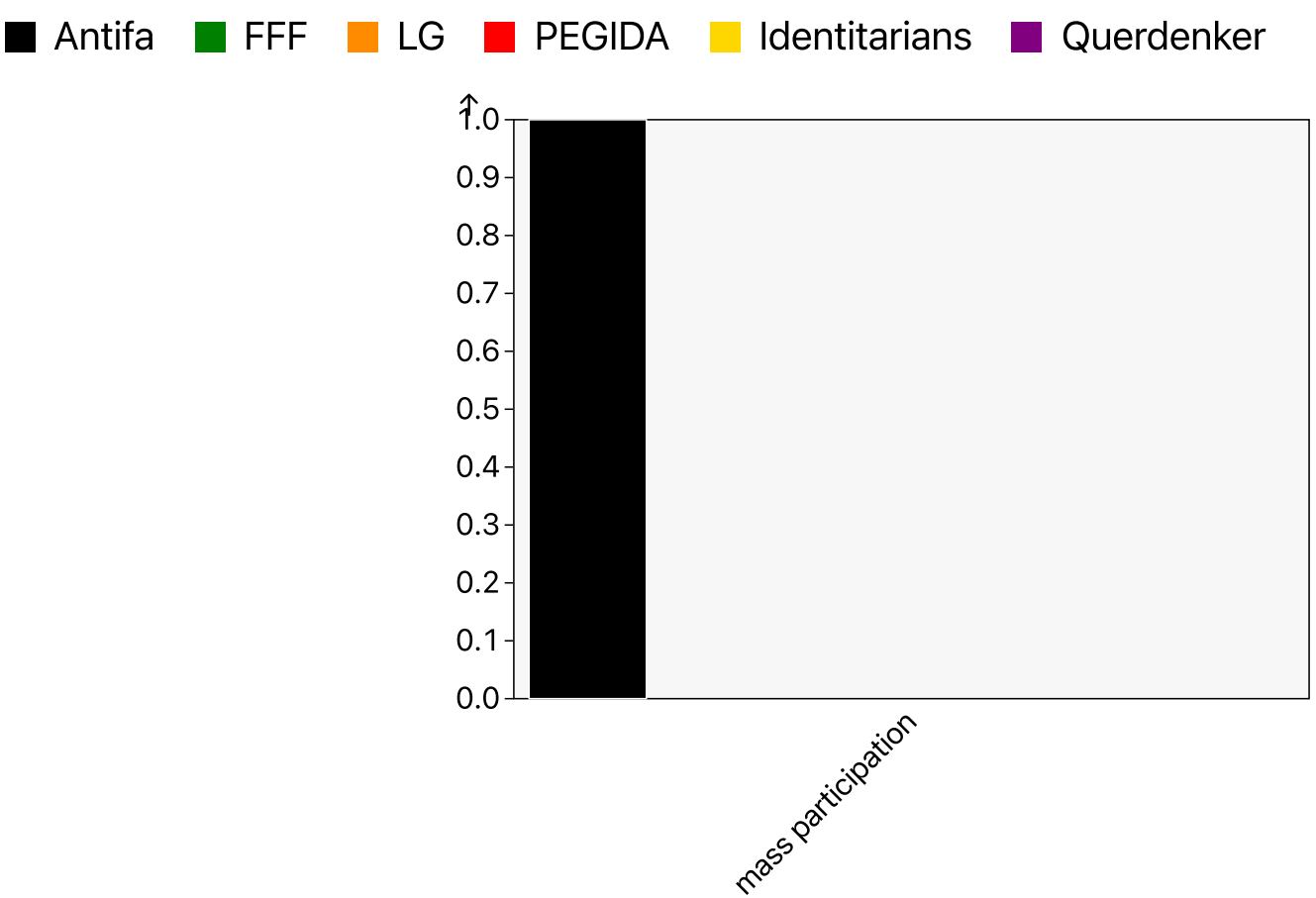
Movement responses - social media

movement relies heavily on social media



Movement responses - key resource

movement's most importance resource for success?



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Organisations

- opening question
- ‘necessity’ of organisations
- emergence and persistence
- types of organisations
- key developments



Opening question

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What types of social movement organisations exist? What are the key differentiating attributes?

Necessity of organisations

> Movements are not based on networks alone; without some degree of **formal organization**, movements frequently fade away or dissipate their energies. (Tarrow 2011, 146)

BUT… to what extent/degree is *organisation* helpful?

Tarrow (2011, 160): if organisations formalise/institutionalise, may lose capacity for disruption; but if they lack infrastructure, they may be unable to sustain interaction with allies, authorities, supporters

Organisations: emergence and persistence

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1. orgs emerge out of episodes of contention
2. orgs begin locally and scale up/spread through contention
    - has the internet changed this?
3. key to org survival is interpersonal networks within them (cf. Ganz 2010 on org. structure enhancing strategic capacity)

Organisations: emergence and persistence

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Organisations: emergence and persistence

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- difference between bureaucratic organisations and grassroots radical organisations – one common org. type distinction



AFL-CIO: heavily formalised org., traditional bargaining tactics (ineffective), *failed to win concessions from growers*



Cesar Chavez, in plaid shirt, marches with members of the United Farm Workers outside a Delano, California, supermarket, August 25, 1975. (AP Photo/Walter Zeboski)

UFW: experienced leaders willing to listen to new ideas, org structure facilitating vertical exchange (creates tactical innovation and strategic capactity), *won concessions*

Different types of movement orgs. (per Tarrow 2011

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- **Exclusive affiliations**:
  - demand long membership accession, rigid discipline, high level of commitment
  - closed off to outside
- **Multiple affiliations**:
  - not monopolising members' commitment
  - multiple commitments is a source of strength
  - facilitates circulation of information, especially through informal/interpersonal networks

How do these different types relate to our discussion of framing?
- recall frame alignment (esp. 'bridging' and 'extenstion')

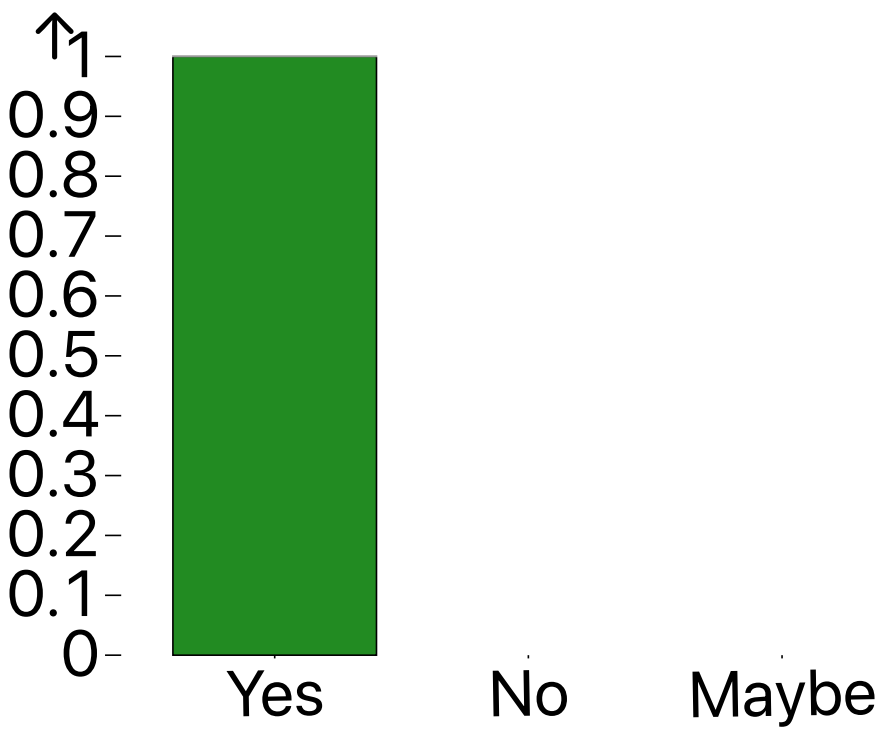
SM orgs. - key developments (Tarrow 2011, 133f)

1. enhanced **availability of the media** (TV, internet) in diffusing the influence of movement organisations
2. increased **amount of money, free time, and expertise available to young people** since the beginning of the postwar boom years
3. **financial and administrative resources available** to movement organisations from foundations, from governments, and even, in some cases, from business and civic groups

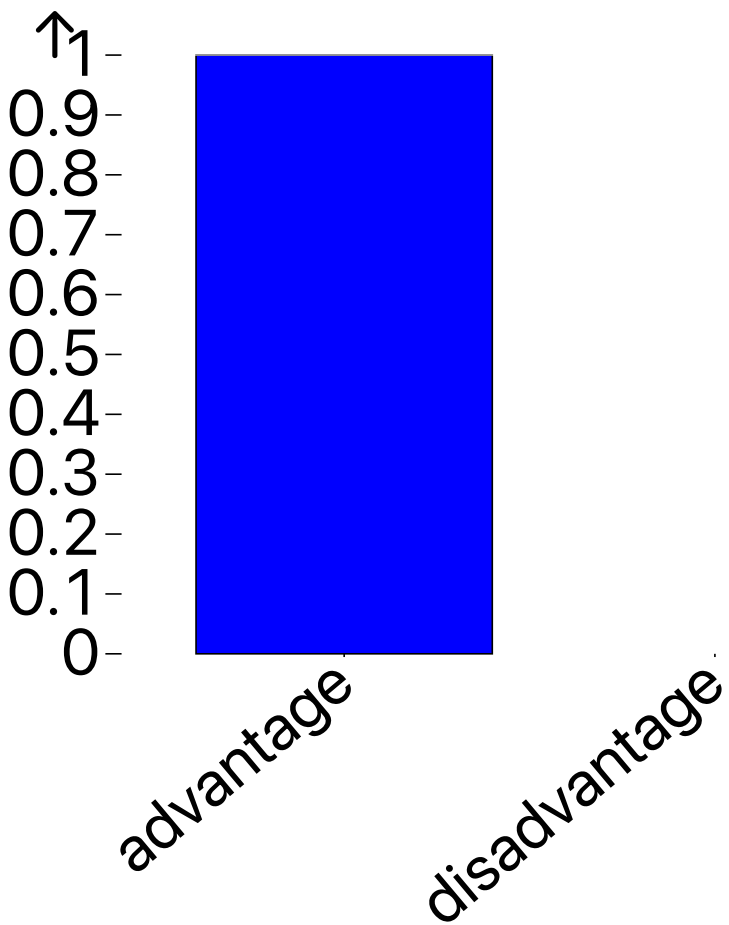
- uses of internet/social media
  - fundraising, share ideology and propaganda, provide training and recruitment opportunities, overcome constraints/counteraction of authorities/opponents

Concluding considerations

young people more prominent, numerous in activism?



if more young people in activism, advantage or disadvantage?



Concluding considerations

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Any questions, concerns, feedback on this class?

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Anonymous feedback here: https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

Questions about movements next meeting: (1) Which identity is most strongly emphasised? (2) Which "out-group" is most frequently part of the group's narratives? (3) Are emotional appeals more important than factual or technical arguments? (4) Are positive emotions more important than negative emotions in sustaining participation? (5) Which emotion seems most central to the movement's mobilisation?

References

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